EVALUATING EARLY REFUGEE RESETTLEMENT EXPERIENCES IN THE UNITED STATES

AI generated image of a refugee family in a family consultation center

INTRODUCTION TO THE SURVEY

Thank you for taking part in this survey. This study is being conducted to understand the experiences of refugees who arrived in the United States through different resettlement pathways, including the Welcome Corps private sponsorship program and the traditional U.S. Refugee Admissions Program (USRAP). The purpose of this survey is to learn about the kinds of support refugees received after arrival, their use of public assistance programs, and their views about how adequate that support was during the early period of resettlement.

Your participation is voluntary. You may skip any question you do not wish to answer, and you may stop completing the survey at any time. Your responses will be kept confidential and will not affect your immigration status, benefits, or relationship with any sponsor, resettlement agency, or service provider. This survey is for adults age 18 and older who arrived in the United States as refugees.

GENERAL INSTRUCTIONS

Please complete this questionnaire based on your own experience after arriving in the United States. This survey has 5 parts and should take about 12–15 minutes to complete. For each question, please mark only one answer unless the question asks you to select more than one. If you make a mistake, please cross out the incorrect answer clearly and mark your new answer. If you do not wish to answer a question, you may leave it blank.

If you have questions about this survey, please contact the research team at (312) 555-1847 or email refugeesurvey@uchicago.edu. Once you complete the survey, please return it to Illinois Family Services, 1155 E 60th Street, Chicago, IL 60637.

PART 1 - BASIC BACKGROUND INFORMATION

Mark (X) ONE box for each question unless otherwise noted.

1. What is your age?

- ☐ 18 – 24
- ☐ 25 – 34
- ☐ 35 – 44
- ☐ 45 – 54
- ☐ 55 or above

2. In what year did you first arrive in the United States as a refugee?

- ☐ Before 2023
- ☐ 2023
- ☐ 2024
- ☐ 2025
- ☐ Prefer not to say

3. When you first arrived in the United States, which type of resettlement support did you receive?

- ☐ Welcome Corps or private sponsor group
- ☐ Traditional Refugee Resettlement Agency (USRAP)
- ☐ Another pathway
- ☐ Not sure

4. What is the highest level of education you completed before arriving in the United States?

- ☐ No formal schooling
- ☐ Primary school
- ☐ Secondary school
- ☐ Some college or vocational training
- ☐ University degree or higher

5. When you first arrived in the United States, if at all, how well could you speak English?

- ☐ Not at all
- ☐ A little
- ☐ Fairly well
- ☐ Very well

6. Including yourself, how many people currently live in your household?

Number of people: _____

PART 2 - USE OF GOVERNMENT ASSISTANCE

Mark (X) ONE box for each question.

7. Since arriving in the United States, have you ever received government food assistance, sometimes called SNAP or EBT?

- ☐ Yes
- ☐ No
- ☐ Not sure

8. Since arriving in the United States, have you ever received government health insurance, such as Medicaid?

- ☐ Yes
- ☐ No
- ☐ Not sure

9. Since arriving in the United States, have you ever received government cash assistance, such as temporary cash support from a federal, state, or local program?

- ☐ Yes
- ☐ No
- ☐ Not sure

10. **Answer this question only if you answered "Yes" to Questions 7, 8, or 9.** After arriving in the United States, for about how long did you receive any government food, medical, or cash assistance? Mark (X) ONE box.

- ☐ Less than 3 months
- ☐ 3 – 6 months
- ☐ 7 – 12 months
- ☐ More than 12 months
- ☐ Not sure

PART 3 - ADEQUACY OF RESETTLEMENT SUPPORT

For each question, mark (X) ONE box. Follow the skip instructions after "No" or "Not sure."

11. During your first 3 months in the United States, did you receive any resettlement support from resettlement agencies, private sponsors, community organizations, family members, or others?

- ☐ Yes
- ☐ No
- ☐ Not sure

→ Skip to Question 12

11a. If yes, how adequate or inadequate was the help you received during resettlement?

☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
Very adequate	Somewhat adequate	Neither adequate nor inadequate	Somewhat inadequate	Very inadequate

12. Did you receive any help in finding safe and stable housing after arriving in the United States?

☐ Yes

☐ No

☐ Not sure

→ Skip to Question 13

12a. If yes, how adequate or inadequate was the help you received in finding safe and stable housing?

☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
Very adequate	Somewhat adequate	Neither adequate nor inadequate	Somewhat inadequate	Very inadequate

13. Did you receive any help in finding a job or preparing for work in the United States?

☐ Yes

☐ No

☐ Not sure

→ Skip to Question 14

13a. If yes, how adequate or inadequate was the help you received in finding a job or preparing for work?

☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
Very adequate	Somewhat adequate	Neither adequate nor inadequate	Somewhat inadequate	Very inadequate

14. Did you receive any help in understanding and using health care services in the United States?

☐ Yes

☐ No

☐ Not sure

→ Skip to Question 15

14a. If yes, how adequate or inadequate was the help you received in understanding and using health care services in the United States?

☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
Very adequate	Somewhat adequate	Neither adequate nor inadequate	Somewhat inadequate	Very inadequate

PART 4 - COMMUNITY INTEGRATION

Mark (X) ONE box for each question.

15. During your **first 3 months** in the United States, how many people, such as family members, friends, sponsors, caseworkers, neighbors, or other adults you knew personally, could you ask for help if you had a serious personal, financial, housing, or health problem?

- ☐ No one
- ☐ 1 person
- ☐ 2 – 3 people
- ☐ 4 – 5 people
- ☐ More than 5

16. During your **first year** in the United States, how welcomed or unwelcome did you feel by people in your community?

☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
Very welcome	Somewhat welcome	Neutral	Somewhat unwelcome	Very unwelcome

17. During your **first 3 months** in the United States, did you spend time in temporary housing, such as a shelter, hotel, shared house, or another short-term place to stay, arranged by a resettlement agency, sponsor group, or another organization?

- ☐ Yes
- ☐ No
- ☐ Not sure

PART 5 - PERSONAL EXPERIENCE

Please write your answer in the space provided in a few short sentences.

18. During your **first year** in the United States, what was the one most helpful type of support you received?

19. What was the biggest challenge you faced during your first year in the United States?

20. Thinking about your **first year** in the United States, what is one thing that could have been done differently to improve the support you received?

Thank you for your participation. Please place the completed questionnaire in the postage-paid return envelope. If the envelope has been misplaced, please mail the questionnaire to Illinois Family Services, 1155 E 60th Street, Chicago, IL 60637.